B1+ LESSON 2





Child Labour

Introduction

The key points of this lesson are:

- There are many places around the world where children are obliged to work, often in conditions that are dangerous for their lives. This is what is called *child labour*.
- Child labourers don't go to school.
- Child labour is a violation of children's rights and an obstacle to the realisation of SDG 8, 'Promote sustained, inclusive and sustainable economic growth, full and productive employment and decent work for all.'

STEP 1 RAISING AWARENESS

1 A/B **Put Ss into pairs to answer and discuss the questions. Use this first step to show the difference between *child labour* and *work done by children*.**

The International Labour Organisation (ILO) defines child labour as work which:

- deprives children of their dignity.
- is dangerous for a child's physical or mental development.
- interferes with a child's right to education.

For further information, see https://www.ilo.org/ipec/facts/lang--en/index.htm.

STEP 2 GOING AHEAD

2 A **Ask Ss to make notes in preparation for reading the report extract.**

B **Ss read the extract and compare it with their ideas in Ex 2A.**

C **Ss read the extract again and complete the gaps with phrases a–g.**

ANSWERS:
1 c **2** f **3** e **4** b **5** a **6** d **7** g

D **Ask Ss to try to complete this exercise without referring back to the text, to see how much they can remember. Put them into pairs to check their answers and look back at the text for confirmation.**

ANSWERS:
1 d **2** b **3** e **4** a **5** c

Language for citizenship

3 **Ss complete the text with the phrases in the box.**

ANSWERS:
1 help your parents at home
2 outside school hours
3 don't interfere with your right to education
4 under the minimum legal age

CRITICAL THINKING

The Italian Constitution

4 **The Italian Constitution doesn't set the minimum age of admission to work. Students are asked to search online for the information which is given here. It should be noted that children under the age of sixteen cannot work.**

L'età minima di ammissione al lavoro è fissata al momento in cui il minore ha concluso il periodo di istruzione obbligatoria e comunque non può essere inferiore a 16 anni (L. 296/2006, art. 1, comma 622), o a 15 nell'ambito delle attività di PCTO.

(The minimum age of admission to work is set at the time when the minor has completed the period of compulsory education and in any case cannot be less than 16 years (L. 296/2006, art. 1, paragraph 622), or 15 in the context of 'PCTO' activities.)

STEP 3 TAKING ACTION

Digital literacies

5 A **The activity suggested here is a way to make students reflect on child labour as a violation of children's rights. Ask Ss: *Why is child labour a violation of children's rights?* If there is time, Ss could explore the text of the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child online and highlight the articles of the Convention which are being violated when child labour occurs. (Answers: Articles 6, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 15, 16, 19, 22, 23, 24, 27, 28, 31, 32, 34, 35, 36, 37 and 38)**

Explain to Ss that to create an acrostic poem, the word is written vertically as the first letter of each line.

ANSWER:
RIGHTS

B/C **Before they write their poems, ask Ss to write 'CHILD LABOUR' vertically in their notebooks, and brainstorm words or phrases they can use. Ss can work together and write their ideas next to the letters.**

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